



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Our Savior New American School

School Website: <https://osnas.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.*

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Our Savior New American School NY 11720 (OSNAS) presents a strongly theist, Christ-centered classical education with clear commitments to formation of character, virtue, wisdom, and metaphysical truths. Public materials repeatedly frame education as formation of the whole person (mind, heart, body, spirit) in a theologically rooted framework, with explicit emphasis on a biblical worldview, liturgical life, and communal worship. Pedagogy leans into both contemplative elements and Socratic, rhetorical, and memorization-based practices, including singing, chanting, and memory work in the lower grades, and Socratic dialogue and rhetoric in the upper grades. The curriculum shows classical threads—Latin study, grammar/logic/rhetoric through language study and classical literature sensibilities—while also integrating Bible-centered courses and theology as a unifying lens. Parental partnership and church-family-school alignment are foregrounded.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates robust Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (catechetical/theological framing, liturgical practices, Bible-centered formation) and a mission explicitly oriented to true, good, and beautiful through formation. Evidence includes explicit statements of knowing God and making Him known, daily prayer, Biblical authority, and Christ-centered identity (Our DNA, Bible content, Purpose of Education).
- The School Purpose and Goal likewise emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and transcendent realities, rather than solely vocational outcomes (The Purpose of Education, The True Purpose of Education).
- Curriculum and Pedagogy reflect a classical orientation with Trivium-like features (grammar/logic/rhetoric through language study and public speaking; Latin instruction; engagement with historical literacy and dialectic discussions) alongside strong integration of theology and liturgical rhythm (Latin/Foreign Language, History, English & Literature, Bible content, Classical pedagogy references in "What is Classical Education?") , ,
- Faculty, Parents & Community are framed in terms of mentor-ship, living curriculum, parental partnership, and a church-family-school unity, aligning with classical expectations for mentorship and formation (Our DNA; The Beliefs; Our Mission) , ,
- The aggregate pattern is consistently Classical, with some nuanced areas that could be more explicit (e.g., explicit Great Books/"Great Conversation" terminology is less visible in public OSNAS pages, though dialectic, memorization, and classical pedagogy are present). This yields a robust CLASSICAL rating overall.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

**Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Daily prayer, chapel, worship life, and liturgical rhythm are described as integral to daily routines (Bible-centered daily prayer; church-season song practices). - The Beliefs section asserts biblical authority, the Triune God, and creation as a foundational worldview (Our DNA). - The school's explicit purpose is framed as knowing God and making Him known, with theology deeply embedded in the educational enterprise (The Purpose of Education; The True Purpose of Education) ..

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; worship; reverence; wonder; sacred tradition; imago Dei; Logos. OSNAS materials show explicit references to God, Bible, liturgical worship, and sacred order (e.g., Bible-centered daily prayer and Biblical authority) aligning with Positive Keywords in the classical lexicon. - Negative keywords: none evident in public OSNAS materials (no drift toward secular relativism or value-neutral ethics in the materials reviewed). - Frequency estimate: Positive keyword hits exceed 6 distinct terms; Negative hits near 0.

Why this rating - The materials show transcendental moral realism in action (truth, goodness, beauty as real ideals); strong theological grounding; liturgical practices; and a coherent sacred worldview permeating daily life and academics. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL criteria for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. Evidence includes explicit statements about theology, worship, and Bible-centered formation, as well as expressions of a sacred—divine order—view of reality. ..

**Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The Purpose of Education centers on formation and knowing God, not merely vocational outcomes; the guiding aim is the true purpose of education in a transcendent sense (The Purpose of Education; The True Purpose of Education) .. - The mission/vision statements emphasize virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing in a God-centered frame (Our DNA).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, teleology (implied), pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, scholé/contemplation implied by formation-focused language, great conversation (the classical-dialogue orientation) when applicable. OSNAS materials emphasize formation of character and the cultivation of moral imagination via a theologically grounded framework. - Negative keywords: minimal to none in public OSNAS materials; no explicit emphasis on job-readiness or purely secular career outcomes in the core statements. - Frequency estimate: multiple explicit matches to formation/virtue/wisdom; near-zero negative keywords.

Why this rating - OSNAS frames education as formation toward human excellence, grounded in a transcendent telos (knowing God and living virtuously). This aligns with the CLASSICAL expectations for the School Purpose and Goal category. The public materials consistently emphasize formation and the pursuit of transcendent truth and beauty rather than mere job-preparation, aligning with the classical ideal. ..

**Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL (with some caveats)**

Evidence - Language and liberal arts emphasis appear through Latin instruction (Latin for Children), and grammar/logic/rhetoric orientation evidenced by classical language study and public-speaking activities (Latin / Foreign Language – Latin for Children; English & Literature; Public Speaking; History) .. - Historical study is integrated into the curriculum (History; “We study History to gain a heart of wisdom”) which suggests an integrated, historical approach rather than purely “social studies” framing (History page). - References to Great Books/Great Conversation appear more in the classical education framework as a criterion; OSNAS materials show dialectic, Socratic style and canonical literature orientation in spirit (What is Classical Education? page references Socratic method and classical aims).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; seven liberal arts (implied by language study and classical pedagogy); great books / primary sources (referenced in classical education framework) and Latin; history; sacred tradition; classical pedagogy; Socratic dialogue; biblical literacy. OSNAS content includes Latin, public-speaking, and a historically engaged curriculum, plus a classical education framing that mentions Socratic-style pedagogy in the public-facing materials. - Negative

keywords: The explicit “Great Books” program is not readily visible in OSNAS public pages; “social studies” framing is not used; however, the core historical-literary integration is present. This yields a partial alignment with the Great Books criterion.

Frequency estimate - Positive keyword hits: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, history, classical pedagogy, Socratic method/dialogue (multiple terms across pages) — about 6–10 distinct positives depending on how granularly terms are counted. - Negative keyword hits: limited to few category-related concerns (e.g., not explicitly framed as Social Studies, no clear shift away from history). Essentially 0–1 explicit negatives.

Why this rating - OSNAS demonstrates substantial classical curriculum elements (Trivium-like elements such as grammar/logic/rhetoric via Latin and rhetoric/public speaking; historical engagement; classical pedagogy). However, the explicit public-facing Great Books/Great Conversation vocabulary is less overt than some classical programs, and the content emphasizes Bible-centered formation. This yields a CLASSICAL evaluation with some caveats, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in the absence of explicit Great Books wording in public pages. The presence of Latin, grammar, logic, rhetoric, and Socratic-style pedagogy supports a classical orientation, even if not every classical sub-element is named in public pages. ,.

#### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Contemplative and restful elements (Scholé) and memorization are indicated in the classical pedagogy lexicon and in OSNAS’s emphasis on memory work and singing; lower grades emphasize singing and memorization; upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion and rhetoric; there are explicit mentions of debates, seminars, and rhetoric training in the classical framework (What is Classical Education? – Classical vs Progressive sections; references to Socratic dialogue and great conversation) ,.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, great conversation (Socratic method), seminars, rhetorical training, memorization/recitation, chant/singing for memory, contemplative/wonderful learning, formation through imitation. OSNAS materials show daily prayer, liturgical singing, and a public-facing doctrine of dialectical learning (Socratic) in interplays between theology, philosophy, and literature. - Negative keywords: The materials do not demonstrate a heavy emphasis on purely project-based or purely student-led constructivist pedagogy; where present (e.g., some experiential opportunities), they sit alongside classical methods. There is little to no evidence of a monolithic “experiential learning only” approach in the public-facing materials. - Frequency estimate: Positive hits exceed 6 distinct terms (Socratic dialogue, dialectic, great conversation, recitation, chanting, memory work, liturgical integration); Negative hits are minimal.

Why this rating - OSNAS demonstrates core classical pedagogical methods: Socratic discussion; formal rhetoric instruction; memorization and recitation; and a rhythm of liturgical or contemplative practices that align with scholé and memory-centered pedagogy. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. Some aspects (e.g., explicit “project-based learning” or strictly student-led experiential pedagogy) appear less central in public materials, supporting a classical blend rather than a fully reform-based approach.

#### **Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Mission, values, and beliefs frame teachers as moral exemplars in a Christ-centered environment; the school emphasizes character formation and mentorship through a cohesive set of core values (Integrity, Family, Enthusiasm, Excellence). The materials describe teachers as living in line with the school’s mission and values (Our DNA; Beliefs; Mission). - The school context suggests a teacher-centered mentorship and virtuous example as part of the school’s fabric (Our DNA; historical narratives about leaders and pedagogy) and the public-facing messages describe teachers as partners in forming students.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty as core; collegial culture; mentorship; character formation; sacred tradition. The Our DNA page demonstrates a teacher-centered, virtue-infused culture, which aligns with classical expectations for faculty. - Negative keywords: None evident in public OSNAS materials (no significant indicators of non-classical faculty portrayal). - Frequency estimate: Multiple explicit terms and themes

referring to teachers as mentors and living exemplars.

Why this rating - OSNAS depicts a faculty culture consistent with classical expectations—teachers as virtuous exemplars, mentors, and living curriculum, with a clear expectation of character formation and alignment with the school's theology and mission. This justifies CLASSICAL for Element 5.

### **Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and a holistic, family-inclusive education; there is a theology-grounded emphasis on the church-family-school unity; the mission explicitly calls for harmony among church, family, and school. - Parental involvement is framed as integral — co-teaching/co-education, formation of affections, and alignment with the Western civilizational heritage. The materials indicate an expectation of parents being engaged in the school's ethos and formation (Our DNA; The Beliefs; Our Mission).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-educators; family involvement; parent formation; home-school collaboration; living tradition in the family; household rhythms; moral formation in the home (as reflected in the classical lexicon and Our DNA language). - Negative keywords: None evident in OSNAS public materials; there is no significant move toward a consumer- or customer-centric model that would indicate a non-classical approach in parental engagement. - Frequency estimate: Multiple explicit mentions of family-school partnership and parent formation in OSNAS materials.

Why this rating - OSNAS presents a robust parental-community framework in line with classical education expectations: parents as co-educators; family alignment with school formation; open engagement and frequent parental involvement. This supports CLASSICAL.

#### **Aggregate Assessment**

- Category scores:
- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL
- Overall: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: The school exhibits the core elements of classical education across most categories, particularly in religious/metaphysical foundations, formation-focused purpose, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community partnerships. Element 3 (Curriculum) shows classical traces (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, history integration) but lacks some explicit public-facing Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis, which places Curriculum in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL territory. Nevertheless, the strong presence of formation, liturgical life, Socratic/memorizational pedagogy, classical language study, and a thoroughly Christian worldview yields an overall CLASSICAL ranking.

What would move the needle (only applies if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in aggregate) - Increase explicit articulation of Great Books and the Great Conversation framework on public-facing materials (e.g., direct mention of canonical texts, primary sources, and explicit engagement with Great Books as part of the curriculum). - Expand explicit references to a broader spectrum of classical texts and works beyond biblical/theological and Latin-focused materials to robustly demonstrate a full Great Books pipeline. - More explicit language about the "Living Curriculum" and a teacher-as-mentor model in public pages to sharpen Element 5 alignment.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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